



Cambridge International Examinations
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/31

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2015

READING BOOKLET INSERT

2 hours

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **2** printed pages and **2** blank pages.



Read the passage carefully, and then answer **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

In this transcript, a doctor who believes in homeopathy, a type of alternative medicine, is interviewed for a radio programme by the presenter, Ms Sanderling.

Ms Sanderling: My guest today, Dr Schinkl, is a doctor who diagnoses and treats a whole range of illnesses, just like any other doctor, but his methods are very different from those in mainstream medicine and remain controversial.

Dr Schinkl, most people would say that modern drugs have made striking advances over the past 150 years. Many once fatal diseases, such as smallpox, have even been entirely eradicated from the planet. For many other illnesses, including cancer, modern drugs can either cure or hold at bay the symptoms and improve patients' chances of survival as well as their quality of life. Why do you think that people turn to homeopathy when modern medicine has more than proved its worth?

Dr Schinkl: Well, modern medicine can't cure everything and patients don't always respond well to chemical remedies. Homeopathy is a gentler science. The side-effects of some modern cures often make patients miserable, even if their original symptoms are eased. Conventional doctors consider such people cured even though their drugs may be addictive or may do damage in the long term.

Ms Sanderling: So people turn to homeopathy out of frustration with modern medicine rather than faith in your methods, perhaps?

Dr Schinkl: Not really. There's a lot more to homeopathy than that, or it wouldn't have survived for hundreds of years. Actually, its origins go back thousands of years to the beginnings of civilisation and it's been practised by different cultures across the world since then. People believe in it because it's a system that benefited people centuries before modern medicine made the advances you describe.

Ms Sanderling: Nevertheless, 'folk remedies' and superstitions aren't credible these days, surely?

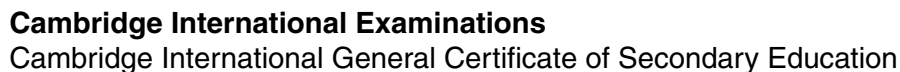
Dr Schinkl: Homeopathy has nothing in common with such practices and has its roots in two basic principles. The first is that the cause of a disease can be used to cure it, an idea used in producing modern medicines too and which goes way back to ancient times. Paracelsus, who many doctors regard as the father of modern medical science, wrote that 'what makes a man ill also cures him.' The second principle is often harder for people to accept. This principle is that the more diluted, or watered down, the remedy is, the more effective it is as a cure. It may seem strange but it works, and has done for centuries.

Ms Sanderling: But how can a tiny quantity of a remedy help to cure disease? Some conventional doctors say that homeopathy is increasing in popularity only because sick people are desperate and willing to try anything – and believe anything, maybe. Research suggests that such cures do no more good than placebos – sugar pills that sometimes have a psychological effect but can't possibly cure diseases in any real sense.

Dr Schinkl: But such research is often carried out by people who profit from modern drugs and there's a lot of ignorance about homeopathic practices. The thousands of people who benefit from homeopathic treatments tell a completely different story!

Ms Sanderling: Speaking of profit, since only tiny quantities of substances are used, and sick people are often desperate for a cure, homeopathic doctors can charge high prices for their services. Is that not exploitative?

Dr Schinkl: Homeopathic remedies are very expensive to produce. They require great subtlety of understanding as well as precision in the preparation of the ingredients. To the millions of patients whose lives have been changed, who have been cured of conditions which conventional doctors had written off as incurable, the benefit is beyond price. None of them has ever complained about the cost! What I say to you, Ms Sanderling, is this: come to me with an incurable condition which is making your life a misery, and I will cure you. Then we shall see how you view homeopathy.



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2 hours

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

No Additional Materials are required.

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do **not** use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **two** questions: **Question 1** in **Section 1** and **one** question from **Section 2**. Answer in the space provided. If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Question 1, Section 1** on this Question Paper. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **11** printed pages and **1** blank page and **1** Insert.

Question 1

In your letter you should

- Base your letter on what you have read in the transcript, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Begin your letter: 'Dear Ms Sanderling, I heard your interview with Dr Schinkl today and felt I had to respond.'

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

[illegible]

[Total: 25]

Section 2: Composition**Questions 2, 3, 4 and 5**

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this Question Paper.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Descriptive Writing

- 2** Describe your thoughts and feelings on an occasion when you were desperate for someone or something to arrive.

OR

- 3** Imagine you are travelling in a cable car which stops unexpectedly. Describe your surroundings and your thoughts and feelings.

OR

Narrative Writing

- 4** You were walking along when someone rushed towards you, asking for help. Write a story which starts at this point.

OR

- 5** Write a story called 'A Way Out'.

[illegible]

[Total: 25]

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is defined by two parallel dotted lines, creating a series of uniform gaps for letter height. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, providing a guide for consistent letter formation. There is no text or other markings on the page.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page, typical of notebook or legal stationery. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.